

Mon, 1 June

Final presentation Brief - Juanita Ocampo

For our final presentation, we decided to focus on the water impact of AI, since it has become an increasingly urgent and relevant issue that affects all of us, often without us even realizing it. It is a topic deeply connected to power, war, and the exploitation of resources that mainly benefit a small group of people, while the rest of us are left to deal with the consequences, almost as if we were puppets within a system we cannot control.

The performance is filled with irony, reflecting how these oligarchs speak from a position of “abundance” while ignoring the voices of communities directly affected by their decisions. In many ways, this dynamic is not new. More than simply saying “don’t use AI,” the performance aims to create awareness about how AI is being used and the impact it generates.

Data centers are not something entirely new, but the industry is growing at an enormous pace, and as consumers, we need to become more conscious of this “AI race” that, instead of constructing a better future, is also contributing to environmental destruction and inequality. We believe there are more ethical and sustainable ways to imagine the future, ways based on equality, collective well-being, and environmental responsibility, rather than the kind of “abundance” promoted by figures like Trump and Elon Musk.

In terms of the coding and visual sequence of the performance, the first part highlights how casually and carelessly we often use AI, asking trivial questions while, at the same time, the water in the code slowly changes color. The piece then transitions into videos showing different actors involved in decisions surrounding data centers, land exploitation, and the environmental and social impact on countries and communities. Finally, the performance ends by questioning these invisible systems and everyday actions that we rarely think about while using AI.

I think one of the things that worked best for me throughout the process was having a clearly defined concept and storytelling structure. It made it much easier to develop the visuals and create a coherent narrative. Working with video was challenging, especially because of the recompile and processing aspects, and I think in the future I would probably prefer working more with images. However, it was also really interesting to explore a new way of using p5live and experiment with a different visual language.